@nour_abou_zour

Comment word HARVEY

# Harvey: the AI agent that finds you new clients

A beginner's setup guide to Harvey, an open-source agent for Claude Code. It finds businesses that fit your offer, writes a personal cold email to each one, watches your inbox, and drafts your follow-ups, all on one dashboard.

| LEVEL | SETUP TIME | HARVEY COST |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Beginner, with patience | 1–2 hours | Free, open source |

It runs on your Claude subscription, with no separate AI bill. You'll also need an email-sending service (explained inside).

# What this guide will help you do

Finding clients usually means hours of searching for businesses, reading their websites, and writing emails one by one. **Harvey** is an open-source agent that does that work with Claude Code.

You tell it **what you sell** and **who your ideal client is**. It finds matching businesses, reads their websites, decides who's worth contacting, and has Claude write a **personal** cold email for each one. It then watches your inbox, spots who's interested, and drafts replies and follow-ups. **You approve every email before it's sent.**

**Harvey has a new name**

Harvey was made by **ethanplusai** on GitHub and has since been renamed **Sellbird**. The old link still works and takes you to the project: github.com/ethanplusai/harvey. Commands may use either name, so always follow the README.

### What's inside


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# How Harvey works

**1. Find** Searches for businesses that match your ideal client. → **2. Research** Reads each business's website. → **3. Decide** Picks who's worth contacting, and who to talk to. → **4. Write** Claude writes a personal email for each one. → **5. Follow up** Watches replies and drafts your answers.

It runs in the background and checks **every 15 minutes** what the next step is, so your computer needs to stay on while it works. It uses **Claude Code** with your existing Claude subscription, so there's no pay-per-use AI bill.

# What you need

| YOU NEED | DETAILS |
|---|---|
| **A Claude subscription with Claude Code** | Harvey runs through Claude Code. Its README says which plan it's designed for (at the time of writing, Claude Max). Because it works all day, a bigger plan helps you avoid usage limits. |
| **A computer that stays on** | Harvey checks for work every 15 minutes while it runs. |
| **An email-sending service** | Harvey connects to a cold-email service to send and track emails. At the time of writing that's **Instantly**, which is a paid service. The README lists what's currently supported. |
| **A separate domain for outreach *(strongly recommended)*** | For example `getyourbrand.com` instead of `yourbrand.com`. If something goes wrong, your main email stays safe. |
| **LinkedIn *(optional)*** | For extra prospect research. |

## 1 Install Harvey

About 15 minutes

1. Open the Claude desktop app, click the **Code** tab, start a new **Local** session, and choose a new folder called `Harvey`.
2. Paste this prompt:

COPY THIS PROMPT — Install

```
Install Harvey (now called Sellbird) from https://github.com/ethanplusai/harvey

Read the README first and follow its setup instructions exactly. I'm a beginner on
Windows / Mac, so explain each step in one simple sentence before you do it.
Tell me clearly whenever I need to create an account, connect a service, or paste a key
myself. Never ask me to paste passwords or keys into this chat. Tell me which file or
screen to put them in instead.
```

## 2 Describe your offer and ideal client

15 minutes · the most important step

Harvey is only as good as what you tell it. Be specific: "small businesses" is too vague, while "dental clinics in Dubai with 2–10 dentists and an outdated website" is great.

COPY THIS PROMPT — Your offer and ideal client

```
Set up my Harvey profile:

What I sell: e.g. websites for dental clinics
The result I get for clients: e.g. more online bookings
Price range: e.g. $1,500-$3,000
Ideal client: industry, location, size
Signs they need me: e.g. no online booking, old website, few reviews
Who to contact: e.g. the owner or practice manager
Proof I can mention: e.g. a past result or client (only real ones)
My name and how to reach me: NAME, WEBSITE

Ask me anything that's missing, then save it as my profile.
```

## 3 Set up email sending safely

30 minutes, then 2–3 weeks of warm-up

Cold emails can damage your email reputation if you set them up wrong. Do it properly once:

1. **Buy a separate domain** for outreach, and create an email address on it.
2. **Set up SPF, DKIM and DMARC.** These are settings that prove your emails are really from you. Ask Claude: *"Explain SPF, DKIM and DMARC simply and walk me through setting them up for my domain and email provider."*
3. **Connect the address to your sending service** (such as Instantly), and turn on **warm-up**. It slowly builds your reputation over 2–3 weeks before real sending.
4. **Connect the sending service to Harvey** by following the README. Paste any keys into the place Claude tells you, never into the chat.

> **Don't skip the warm-up**
>
> A brand-new address that suddenly sends lots of emails goes straight to spam, and can get the domain blocked. Patience here saves you weeks of problems.

## 4 Run your first small campaign

Start with 20 businesses

COPY THIS PROMPT — First campaign

```
Start a small test campaign with Harvey: find 20 businesses that match my ideal client.
For each one, show me: the business, why it's a good fit, who to contact, and the
personal email you'd send.
Don't send anything until I approve each email.
```

### What a good email looks like

- **Short:** 4–6 sentences.

- **Personal:** mentions something real about *their* business, not a generic compliment.
- **One clear question** at the end, like "Worth a quick chat?", not a hard sell.
- **Honest:** says who you are, uses no fake familiarity, and offers an easy way to opt out.

Read each draft. Edit, approve or reject it. Rejecting bad emails and explaining why ("too pushy", "wrong person") teaches it what you want.

## 5 Your dashboard

Everything in one place

Harvey has a dashboard that shows every lead, every email and every conversation. Ask Claude to open it:

COPY THIS PROMPT — Open dashboard

```
Start the Harvey dashboard the way the README says, and give me the link to open it in my browser.
```

It runs on your own computer (a link starting with `localhost`), so only you can see it.

## 6 Replies and follow-ups

Where the clients come from

Harvey watches your inbox, works out who's interested, and drafts your replies and follow-ups. Check the dashboard once or twice a day:

- **Interested:** review the drafted reply, make it personal, approve it, and book the call.
- **Not now:** a polite reply. Ask if you can follow up in a few months.
- **Not interested or "remove me":** stop immediately, and make sure they're never contacted again.

**The rules: this is not a spam machine**

- **Approve every email** before it goes out. You're responsible for what's sent in your name.
- **Only contact relevant businesses,** ones with a real reason to care about your offer. Never blast everyone.
- **Keep volume low,** especially at the start, for example 20–30 emails a day per address.
- **Follow the law where you and they are.** Cold email rules (like CAN-SPAM in the US, and GDPR and PECR in Europe and the UK) require things like honest sender details, a way to opt out, and respecting "no". Check what applies to you.
- **Never buy email lists** or invent facts, results or reviews.

# Fixes

| PROBLEM | WHAT TO DO |
| --- | --- |
| **Emails land in spam** | Check SPF, DKIM and DMARC, extend warm-up, send fewer emails, and remove links and images from the first email. |
| **Leads don't fit** | Make your ideal client more specific in Step 2, and reject bad leads with a reason. |
| **Emails feel generic** | Tell it: "Every email must mention one specific thing from their website, and stay under 80 words." |
| **Harvey stopped working** | Your computer may have slept, or you hit your Claude usage limit. Keep the computer awake and check your plan. |
| **A command doesn't exist** | The project was renamed to Sellbird. Ask Claude: "Check the README for the current command name." |

# Your checklist

- [ ] Harvey is installed from the GitHub link, following the README
- [ ] My offer and ideal client profile are specific
- [ ] I use a separate outreach domain with SPF, DKIM and DMARC set up
- [ ] My sending address finished warming up
- [ ] I ran a 20-business test and approved each email myself
- [ ] I can open the dashboard and see leads, emails and conversations
- [ ] I stop instantly for anyone who says no

## Mini glossary

| | |
|---|---|
| **Ideal client profile** | A clear description of the exact type of business that needs what you sell. |
| **Lead / prospect** | A business that might become a client. |
| **Cold email** | An email to someone you haven't spoken to before. |
| **Deliverability** | Whether your emails land in the inbox or in spam. |
| **Warm-up** | Slowly building a new email address's reputation before real sending. |
| **SPF / DKIM / DMARC** | Email settings that prove your messages really come from you. |

### Fewer, better emails win.

Let Harvey do the searching and the first drafts. You bring the judgement and the human touch, and that's what turns replies into clients.

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